

SMARTWATCHES

Is it the right time to invest in a Smartwatch? Or is wearable tech still in its infancy?

Jayesh Shinde

Wearable tech is exploding all around us, right from heads-up displays to fitness trackers; and of course smartwatches. Just on the block and they're already a dime a dozen, aren't they? Before you go on to buy one this festive season, read on what things to mull on.

Two of our biggest problems with smartwatches are that they're way too expensive at the moment and need to be charged often (like your smartphone). Having gotten that out of our systems, here's some buying advice.

STYLE MATTERS

If you're going to spending more than ₹8,000 to ₹10,000 for a smartwatch, it's safe to assume that beauty will matter. In stark contrast to quintessential expensive traditional wristwatches, the



The Moto 360 Smartwatch

current crop of smartwatches (barring one or two exceptions) all appear to be made for Star Trek characters. It will look good on a college kid's hand, or when you're out jogging in the morning, but forget about sporting one in a boardroom meeting unless it's Futuristic-themed Casual Friday. Don't buy from online sites, we recommend you touch and feel the smartwatch you want to purchase before putting money on the table.

(IN)DEPENDENT?

First things first, most smartwatches released till date act as second-screen devices for your smartphone. There are very few watches that enjoy an unsheltered, unpaired existence. So yeah, check their IQ before purchasing one, and assess the reality of having to live with two screens.

COMPATIBILITY

Most smartwatches in the market aren't compatible with all devices. The first thing you should examine is at the device-platform compatibility claims of any smartwatch. Some smartphone OEMs like to keep their smartwatches compatible exclusively with their phones. Others are more forgiving and have a list of companion smartphones. Very few smartwatches are able to work with all major platforms.

APPS

More apps mean more functionality. Most smartwatches right now suffer from very limited bundled apps and a virtually non-existent developer community. Obviously, this will change for the better but for now, there isn't much to do with a smartwatch other than use it as a fitness tracker or as a companion device.

SENSORS

Most smartwatches in the market are camouflaged, chic-looking fitness bands, given the amount of sensors they pack in. What's more, the line dividing smartwatches and fitness bands is quite thin, at the moment.



The Galaxy Gear 2

SMART OR NOT?

It's cool to be an early adopter and start a trend, we get that, but it's still early days for smartwatches. They're still a work in progress and have the scope to be so much more. A wiser person would wait till next year, but a watch enthusiast, perhaps, may not. **d**

**Online transaction
mein fraud se darte ho?
Toh mera laptop le lo.**

Fraud-proof hai! **Kaise? Aise!**

For more details, visit: www.quickheal.com/totalsecurity



Quick Heal®

Total Security with

Safe Online Transaction